

each,” don’t feel badly about taking them all. These toothbrushes weren’t an advertised special that other customers were expecting to be on the shelf. If you know you truly won’t use twenty toothbrushes but that coupon is expiring in a few days, you essentially have three choices: buy them anyway and donate them to a food bank or shelter, be a “coupon fairy” and leave a few coupons near the marked-down brushes for the next delighted consumer to discover, or pass over the deal entirely.

Price match. If you don’t want to trek all over town to pick up the best deals, find a store that price matches and bring your ads in for one-stop shopping. Some stores will also accept competitor’s coupons.

Keep an eye on the register. If you can’t keep an eye on the cashier because you are busy attending to children or emptying the contents of your cart onto the conveyer belt, double check your receipt before you leave the store. You will want to make sure all your coupons were taken off and the sale prices rang up correctly.

Always remember couponing etiquette. Be polite and patient. You are never entitled to the coupon savings, and store managers do not have to accept coupons. Coupons are a privilege, not a right. You are doing yourself no favors if you enter stores with an attitude of entitlement just because you’ve been watching the crazy couponers on television!

And, finally, don’t forget the cardinal rule of couponing: if you miss out on a great deal, don’t fret and fume. There will always be another sale.